Assignment 1 - Git & GitHub Fundamentals

Session 1 - Group C | Individual Lab Report | 14 October 2026

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1. Repository Setup

I extracted the provided starter files into git-session1-Mohamed-Taha85 and initialized the repository on the main branch using git init -b main. I created a .gitignore file to exclude local.env and ordinary *.log files, while allowing important.log with !important.log. I verified the rules with git status and git check-ignore.

2. README & Commit History

My README includes my name and GitHub username, a description of the project, the technologies used, a Git command example, a profile link, and the provided banner image. I made separate commits for the initial setup, JavaScript status message, CSS change, About page, and homepage navigation. I used meaningful commit messages and checked the history with git log --oneline.

3. Selective Staging

I modified app.js and style.css at the same time. I staged only app.js using git add app.js and committed it while style.css remained modified but unstaged. After checking the staged and unstaged diffs, I committed the CSS change separately. The terminal screenshot shows both states.

4. Branch & Merge

I created feature/about with git switch -c feature/about, added about.html, and then added its link to index.html in a second feature commit. I switched back to main and merged the branch with git merge --no-ff feature/about. The Git graph shows the two branch commits and merge commit.

5. Remote Changes

Commit saves staged changes in the local repository; push sends local commits to GitHub. I published main to my empty GitHub repository, then edited README.md directly on GitHub. Fetch updated my remote-tracking information without changing local main; git status showed it was behind by one commit. Pull then fast-forwarded my local branch. A final diff between main and origin/main was empty.

6. Fair Use of AI

I used ChatGPT as a guide while completing this lab. I asked for step-by-step explanations of Git commands, help planning the commits, examples for the README and About page, and help fixing a mistake when I accidentally created c.gitignore instead of .gitignore. I used the suggested commands and text, but I ran the commands myself and checked their results using git status, git diff, git log, git check-ignore, and the files displayed on GitHub. I also captured screenshots of the required states rather than relying only on the AI explanations.

7. Sources & Reflection

Sources: Course assignment handout and starter files; my Git Bash results; my GitHub repository; ChatGPT guidance.

Reflection: Selective staging was the hardest concept because a file can be modified without being included in the next commit. If Git behaves unexpectedly, I would first run git status and then inspect the relevant diff, current branch, or remote configuration before making another change.

Repository: github.com/Mohamed-Taha85/git-session1-Mohamed-Taha85

Evidence - Local Git Workflow

Figure 1. Selective staging: app.js is staged while style.css remains modified and unstaged.

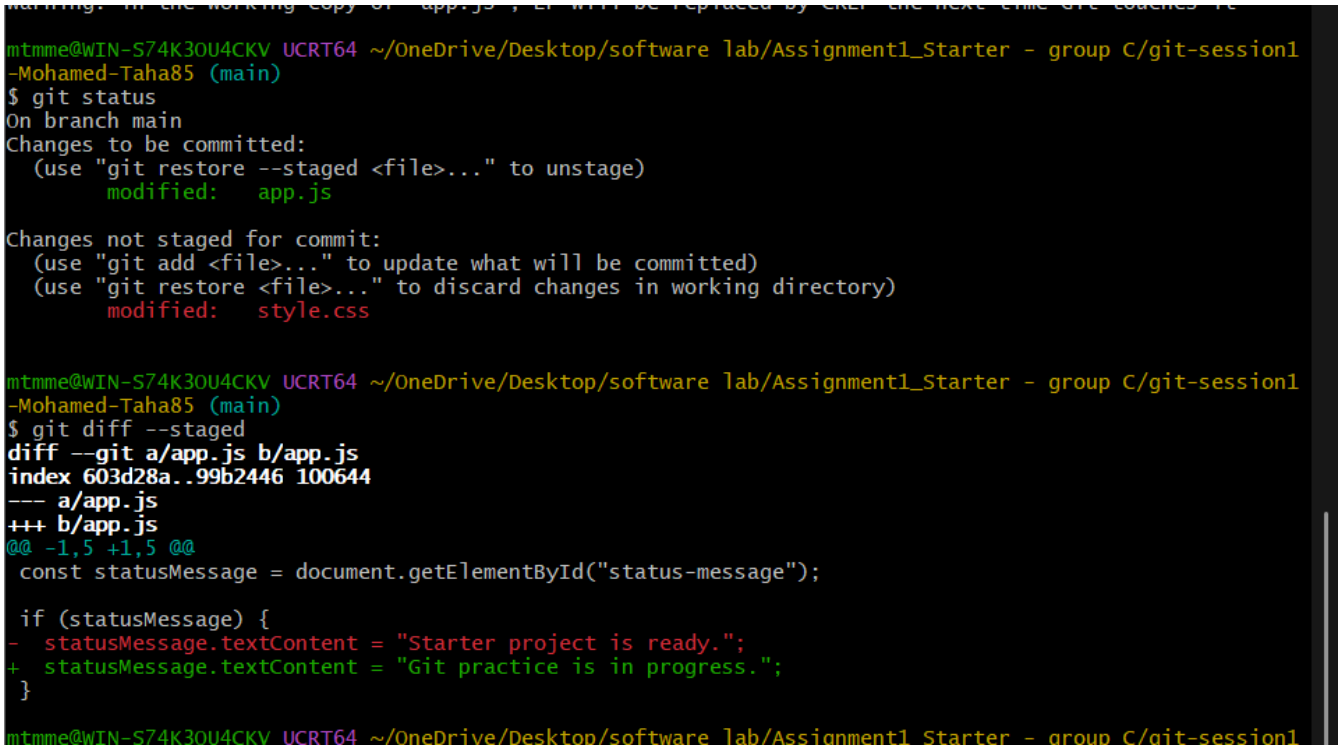
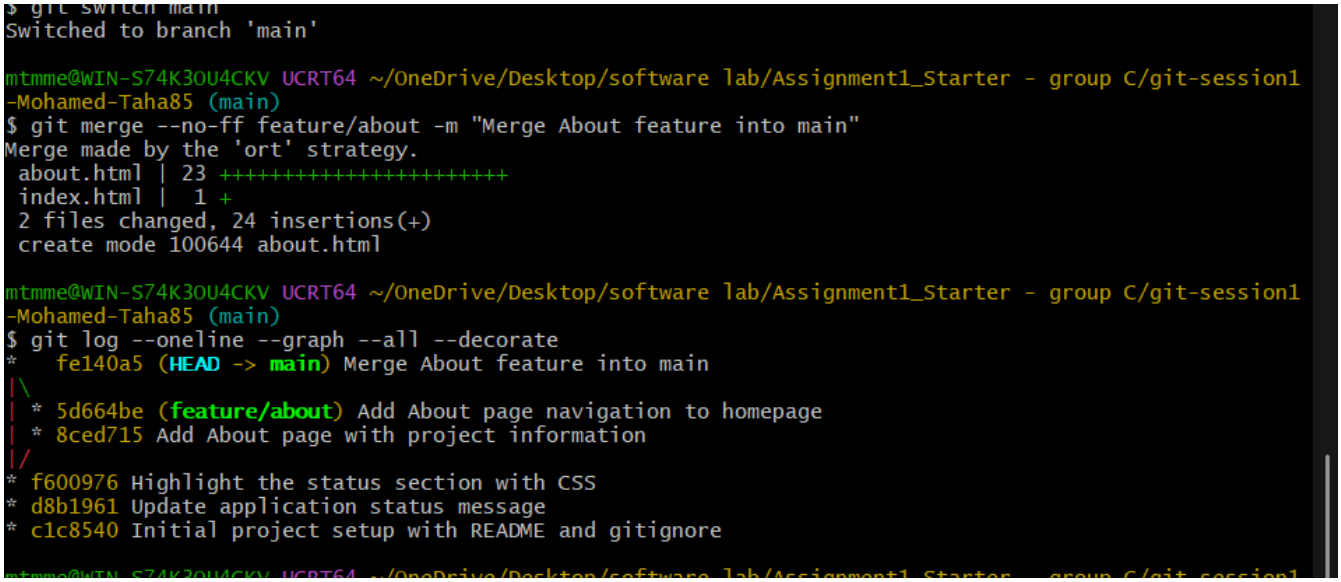


Figure 2. The About feature is merged into main; the graph retains the two feature commits.



Evidence - GitHub & Synchronization

Figure 3. After git fetch, local main is one commit behind origin/main, with no working-tree changes.

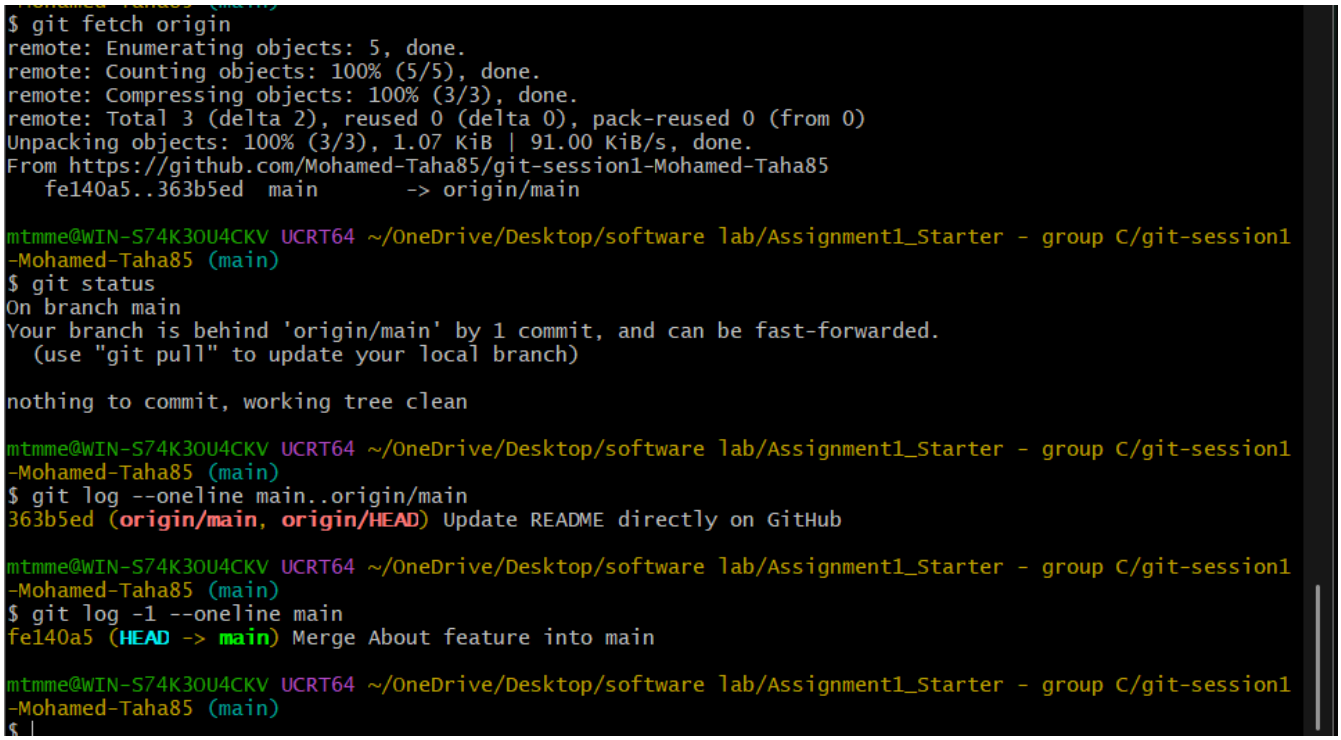


Figure 4. Published GitHub repository: project files, important.log, and public visibility.

